Panacea

DEFINE · DESIGN · DEVELOP · DEPLOY

AI SDLC - PANACEA

Every engineer runs a team.

Panacea is KPMG's AI software development lifecycle. It turns one engineer into a supervised fleet of coding agents, and it ties every release back to the requirement that asked for it, on our own cloud, under our own controls.

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CONFIDENTIAL, KPMG AND AUTHORISED RECIPIENTS

THE CASE

AI is already in our delivery. It is not yet in our control.

Engineers across the firm are using AI coding assistants today. The productivity is real. So is the exposure, and it compounds quietly, because none of it is visible from where you sit.

1 What ungoverned adoption costs

Client code leaves the perimeter

Personal subscriptions, consumer terms, and retention policies nobody has read. Source that belongs to a client sits in an account that belongs to an individual.

The audit trail thins

Work is produced faster than the reasoning behind it is recorded. When a regulator or a client asks why something was built, the honest answer is increasingly a reconstruction.

Quality becomes personal

Output quality tracks whoever is holding the tool. There is no firm standard, because there is no firm platform to put one in.

The value walks out

Every prompt, pattern and workflow that makes an engineer effective is learned privately and leaves with them.

2 Why point tools do not solve it

An assistant inside the editor makes one step of the lifecycle faster. It does not know what was agreed in the requirement, it does not carry that agreement into the design, and it cannot tell you at release time which commitment a given change discharges. The lifecycle is unchanged. The governance gap is unchanged. Buying more seats widens both.

Define → Design → Develop → Deploy

ONE PLATFORM, ONE THREAD, ONE PLACE TO GOVERN IT

3 The position this puts KPMG in

A firm that can demonstrate governed, auditable, AI-accelerated delivery is in a materially different conversation with a regulated client than one that cannot. That demonstration is not a policy document. It is a platform, and it is the same platform our own engineers use every day.

THE SOLUTION

One platform, from the ask to the release

Panacea takes a person from nothing to a shipped application and owns the whole journey. Four phases, one project, one thread of evidence running through all of them.

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT THE BUSINESS GETS
Define	The requirement is captured and challenged until every acceptance criterion is one that can actually be proven.	A versioned, immutable statement of what was agreed.
Design	The interface is designed on a real canvas, with agents editing real frames rather than describing changes in prose.	A design that is traceably an answer to the requirement.
Develop	A fleet of agents builds in parallel, each on its own isolated machine and its own branch, supervised from one window.	Throughput that scales with supervision, not with headcount.
Deploy	The release is assembled with the evidence for each criterion attached, and pinned to the exact requirement it satisfies.	A release you can sign off on evidence rather than assurance.

4 The shift that matters

One engineer, many agents
The unit of work is a supervised session on its own machine. A person runs several at once and reviews, rather than typing.

Context is an asset
The requirement is an object with an identity that every later stage references. It is never retyped, so it never drifts.

Done means proven
Each criterion arrives at release with the evidence that discharges it. Completion is demonstrated, not asserted.

5 What an engineer sees

One window. Every live session in it, each a real terminal with a real agent working in a real repository. Start work, watch several streams at once, intervene where judgement is needed, and merge the results. The skill being exercised is direction and review, which is the skill that scales.

RUNS ON THE DESKTOP · RUNS ON OUR CLOUD · WORKS WITH THE TOOLS ENGINEERS ALREADY USE · NO CONFIGURATION TO REACH THE VALUE

OUTCOMES

What changes for the firm

The platform is a means. These are the ends, and they are the terms the investment should be judged in.

6 Delivery

CAPACITY	An engineer supervises several streams of work at once instead of writing one. Capacity grows without proportional hiring, and it grows fastest for the senior people whose judgement was the bottleneck.
CONSISTENCY	Standards, review gates and evidence requirements live in the platform, so every engagement gets them by default rather than by discipline.
ONBOARDING	A new joiner inherits the firm's way of working from the tool on day one, including the context of the project they have joined.
RETENTION OF METHOD	The workflows that make our best people effective become firm assets held in the platform, not private habits.

7 Assurance

TRACEABILITY	Requirement to design to change to release, mechanically linked. Produced as a by-product of doing the work rather than assembled afterwards for an audit.
EVIDENCE	Every acceptance criterion carries its proof. A criterion with nothing attached is reported as outstanding rather than quietly assumed.
ISOLATION	Agent work happens inside a dedicated virtual machine, not on an engineer's laptop and not in a shared runtime.
RESIDENCY	Each project's data classification decides where its inference runs. Australian data stays in Australia, and a project that may not leave the country will stop rather than fall back.

8 Commercial

Panacea is built for regulated enterprise on the customer's own cloud, which is precisely the configuration our clients ask for and the one the market does not currently serve. What we build to run KPMG delivery is the same thing we can stand up inside a client's tenancy. The internal investment and the client-facing proposition are the same asset.

> **THE SIMPLEST STATEMENT OF THE VALUE**
>
> We stop paying for AI assistance that we cannot see, cannot standardise and cannot evidence, and we start running it as firm infrastructure that produces its own audit trail.

CONTROLS

Governed by construction

Every control below is a property of the architecture rather than a policy layered over it. These are the answers to the questions technology risk will ask first.

QUESTION	HOW PANACEA ANSWERS IT
Where does our code run?	In KPMG's own cloud tenancy. The platform is deployed into our environment; our source is never delivered into someone else's.
How isolated is an agent?	One virtual machine per session, with its own kernel, read only root filesystem, no host networking and explicit resource limits. An agent is treated as untrusted code, because that is what it is.
Where does our data go?	Through an organisation level gateway with zero data retention. No personal subscriptions, and no organisation key is ever placed inside a sandbox. Sessions receive scoped, short lived credentials only.
Does data stay in Australia?	Data classification is set when a project is created and decides the route. An Australian classified project is served in country and fails closed rather than falling back.
Who is using it?	Each person signs in as themselves through our existing directory, with no new registration required. Usage is attributed per person, team and project.
Can we reconstruct what happened?	The ledger is append only, and requirement revisions are immutable. History cannot be rewritten to look tidier than it was.
What is it made of?	Third party components are permitted only under permissive licences, verified from each component's own licence file. Copyleft and source-available licences are excluded from the shipped product.

DESIGNED FOR THE CLIENT CONVERSATION, NOT JUST OURS

Because the platform runs in the customer's tenancy under the customer's identity provider, the same controls hold when it is stood up for a client. The assurance story does not need rewriting per engagement.

POSITION

Why KPMG owns this rather than rents it

The parts of this that are commodity are bought. The part that is not commodity is the part worth owning, and it is the part no vendor currently sells.

9 What the market offers today

There are excellent assistants for writing code, and there are emerging tools for running several agents at once. Both assume a developer working on their own code, on the vendor's infrastructure, under the vendor's terms. Neither carries a requirement through to a release, and neither is built to be deployed inside a regulated customer's own tenancy under that customer's identity and data controls. That is the gap.

10 What owning it gives us

The method becomes an asset

Our delivery standards, review gates and evidence requirements are encoded in a platform we control, not in guidance people may or may not follow.

No dependency on a vendor's terms

Residency, retention and isolation are ours to set. They do not change because someone else updated a policy page.

A second revenue line

The same platform stands up inside a client tenancy. Internal capability and client offering are one investment, not two.

A credible reference

The strongest proof that governed AI delivery works is a firm that runs its own delivery on it.

11 What we are not building

Not a model, and not a coding assistant. Panacea uses the best available agents unmodified, and changes which one it uses as the market moves. The investment is in the lifecycle around them, which is the part that does not become obsolete when the next model ships.

ADOPTION

How it reaches the firm

Adoption is staged so that value is demonstrated on real delivery before scale is committed, and so that technology risk is engaged at the start rather than at the end.

1. **One team, real work**
   A single delivery team runs an actual engagement on Panacea. Success is judged on delivered work and on the evidence trail it produced, not on a demonstration.

2. **Risk sign off on the real thing**
   Technology risk and security assess the platform as configured for that team, in our tenancy, with our identity provider. The controls on the previous page are what is assessed.

3. **A practice**
   Extension to a practice area, with the firm's delivery standards encoded as the default gates. This is the point at which consistency becomes visible in the output.

4. **The firm standard**
   Panacea becomes the supported way to use AI in delivery, and unmanaged personal tooling is retired rather than merely discouraged.

5. **To clients**
   The same platform, deployed into a client tenancy as part of an engagement, with the assurance position already established internally.

12 What we ask of technology

ENVIRONMENT	A KPMG cloud subscription for the platform, with the capacity to run isolated session machines.
IDENTITY	Sign in through our existing directory, so that people authenticate as themselves with nothing new to provision.
INFERENCE	Organisation level model access under enterprise terms, replacing personal subscriptions.
SPONSORSHIP	A named delivery team, and technology risk engaged from the first stage rather than at the point of rollout.

THE ASK

Make Panacea the firm's AI SDLC

Three decisions, each of which can be taken now and none of which depends on the others being taken first.

1. Adopt the direction

Name Panacea as the intended standard for AI assisted delivery, so that work stops fragmenting across personal tooling while the decision is pending.

2. Provide the environment

A subscription, directory sign in and organisation level model access. This is the dependency that gates everything else.

3. Fund to first engagement

Back the programme to the point where one delivery team is running a real engagement on it, and judge the next step on that.

13 What success looks like at the first review

- A real engagement delivered on the platform, by a team that would otherwise have delivered it conventionally.
- A complete evidence trail from the agreed requirement to the shipped release, produced without anyone assembling it by hand.
- A signed technology risk position on the platform as deployed in our tenancy.
- Engineers who prefer it, measured by whether they go back.

14 The risk of waiting

AI assisted delivery is not a decision the firm gets to defer, because it is already happening. The only open question is whether it happens on infrastructure we control and can evidence, or on accounts we cannot see. Every month of delay adds volume to the second of those, and the cost of moving it later is higher than the cost of directing it now.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Panacea turns AI assisted delivery from a personal productivity tool into firm infrastructure that produces capacity, consistency and an audit trail as the same act.